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für IT-Standards

# **Repository Mirroring Tool Guide**

# Repository Mirroring Tool Guide

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An administrator's guide to Repository Mirroring Tool—a proxy system for SUSE Customer Center with repository and registration targets.

## Revision History

- 17 Jun 2025

Updated for the initial release of SUSE Linux Enterprise Server15 SP7.

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# Preface

## Available documentation

### Online documentation

Our documentation is available online at <https://documentation.suse.com>. Browse or download the documentation in various formats.



#### Latest updates

The latest updates are usually available in the English-language version of this documentation.

### SUSE Knowledgebase

If you run into an issue, check out the Technical Information Documents (TIDs) that are available online at <https://www.suse.com/support/kb/>. Search the SUSE Knowledgebase for known solutions driven by customer need.

### Release notes

For release notes, see <https://www.suse.com/releasenotes/>.

### In your system

For offline use, the release notes are also available under `/usr/share/doc/release-notes` on your system. The documentation for individual packages is available at `/usr/share/doc/packages`.

Many commands are also described in their *manual pages*. To view them, run **man**, followed by a specific command name. If the **man** command is not installed on your system, install it with **sudo zypper install man**.

## Improving the documentation

Your feedback and contributions to this documentation are welcome. The following channels for giving feedback are available:

## Service requests and support

For services and support options available for your product, see <https://www.suse.com/support/>.

To open a service request, you need a SUSE subscription registered at SUSE Customer Center. Go to <https://scc.suse.com/support/requests>, log in, and click *Create New*.

## Bug reports

Report issues with the documentation at <https://bugzilla.suse.com/>.

To simplify this process, click the *Report an issue* icon next to a headline in the HTML version of this document. This preselects the right product and category in Bugzilla and adds a link to the current section. You can start typing your bug report right away.

A Bugzilla account is required.

## Contributions

To contribute to this documentation, click the *Edit source document* icon next to a headline in the HTML version of this document. This will take you to the source code on GitHub, where you can open a pull request.

A GitHub account is required.



### ***Edit source document only available for English***

The *Edit source document* icons are only available for the English version of each document. For all other languages, use the *Report an issue* icons instead.

For more information about the documentation environment used for this documentation, see the repository's README.

## Mail

You can also report errors and send feedback concerning the documentation to `doc-team@suse.com`. Include the document title, the product version, and the publication date of the document. Additionally, include the relevant section number and title (or provide the URL) and provide a concise description of the problem.

## Documentation conventions

The following notices and typographic conventions are used in this document:

- `/etc/passwd`: Directory names and file names
- *PLACEHOLDER*: Replace *PLACEHOLDER* with the actual value
- `PATH`: An environment variable
- `ls, --help`: Commands, options, and parameters
- `user`: The name of a user or group
- `package_name`: The name of a software package
- `Alt`, `Alt-F1`: A key to press or a key combination. Keys are shown in uppercase as on a keyboard.
- *File*, *File* > *Save As*: menu items, buttons
- `x86_64` ► This paragraph is only relevant for the AMD64/Intel 64 architectures. The arrows mark the beginning and the end of the text block. ◀
- `zseries;power` ► This paragraph is only relevant for the architectures `IBM Z` and `POWER`. The arrows mark the beginning and the end of the text block. ◀
- *Chapter 1, “Example chapter”*: A cross-reference to another chapter in this guide.
- Commands that must be run with `root` privileges. You can also prefix these commands with the `sudo` command to run them as a non-privileged user:

```
#command>sudocommand
```

- Commands that can be run by non-privileged users:
- ```
>command
```
- Commands can be split into two or multiple lines by a backslash character (`\`) at the end of a line. The backslash informs the shell that the command invocation will continue after the end of the line:

```
>echo a b \  
c d
```

- A code block that shows both the command (preceded by a prompt) and the respective output returned by the shell:

```
>command  
output
```

- Notices



### **Warning notice**

Vital information you must be aware of before proceeding. Warns you about security issues, potential loss of data, damage to hardware, or physical hazards.



### **Important notice**

Important information you should be aware of before proceeding.



### **Note notice**

Additional information, for example about differences in software versions.



### **Tip notice**

Helpful information, like a guideline or a piece of practical advice.

- Compact Notices



### **Note**

Additional information, for example about differences in software versions.



### **Tip**

Helpful information, like a guideline or a piece of practical advice.

## **Support**

Find the support statement for SUSE Linux Enterprise Server and general information about technology previews below. For details about the product lifecycle, see <https://www.suse.com/lifecycle>.

If you are entitled to support, find details on how to collect information for a support ticket at <https://documentation.suse.com/sles-15/html/SLES-all/cha-adm-support.html>.

## **Support statement for SUSE Linux Enterprise Server**

To receive support, you need an appropriate subscription with SUSE. To view the specific support offers available to you, go to <https://www.suse.com/support/> and select your product.

The support levels are defined as follows:

## L1

Problem determination, which means technical support designed to provide compatibility information, usage support, ongoing maintenance, information gathering and basic troubleshooting using available documentation.

## L2

Problem isolation, which means technical support designed to analyze data, reproduce customer problems, isolate a problem area and provide a resolution for problems not resolved by Level 1 or prepare for Level 3.

## L3

Problem resolution, which means technical support designed to resolve problems by engaging engineering to resolve product defects which have been identified by Level 2 Support.

For contracted customers and partners, SUSE Linux Enterprise Server is delivered with L3 support for all packages, except for the following:

- Technology previews.
- Sound, graphics, fonts, and artwork.
- Packages that require an additional customer contract.
- Some packages shipped as part of the module *Workstation Extension* are L2-supported only.
- Packages with names ending in `-devel` (containing header files and similar developer resources) will only be supported together with their main packages.

SUSE will only support the usage of original packages. That is, packages that are unchanged and not recompiled.

## Technology previews

Technology previews are packages, stacks, or features delivered by SUSE to provide glimpses into upcoming innovations. Technology previews are included for your convenience to give you a chance to test new technologies within your environment. We would appreciate your feedback. If you test a technology preview, please contact your SUSE representative and let them know about your experience and use cases. Your input is helpful for future development.

Technology previews have the following limitations:

- Technology previews are still in development. Therefore, they may be functionally incomplete, unstable, or otherwise *not* suitable for production use.
- Technology previews are *not* supported.
- Technology previews may only be available for specific hardware architectures.
- Details and functionality of technology previews are subject to change. As a result, upgrading to subsequent releases of a technology preview may be impossible and require a fresh installation.
- SUSE may discover that a preview does not meet customer or market needs, or does not comply with enterprise standards. Technology previews can be removed from a product at any time. SUSE does not commit to providing a supported version of such technologies in the future.

For an overview of technology previews shipped with your product, see the release notes at <https://www.suse.com/releasenotes>.

## Chapter 1. Overview

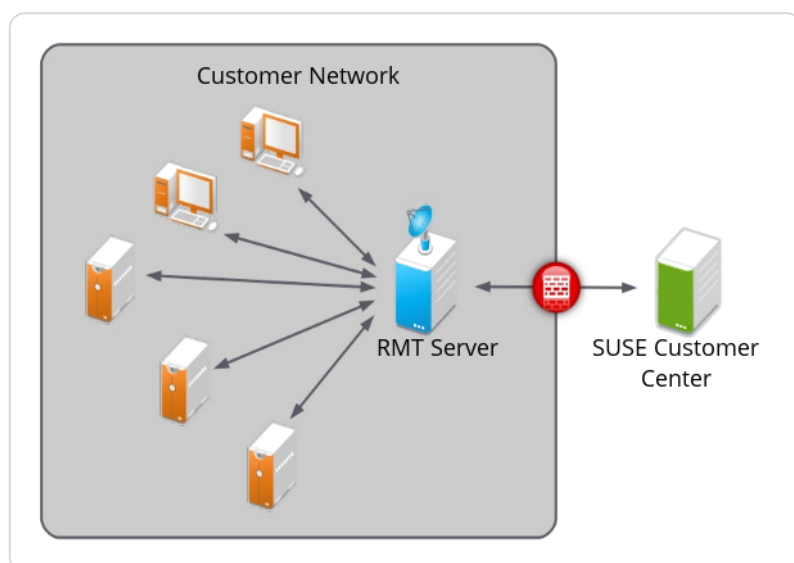
The Repository Mirroring Tool (RMT) for SUSE Linux Enterprise 15 SP7 allows enterprise customers to optimize the management of SUSE Linux Enterprise software updates and subscription entitlements. It establishes a proxy system for SUSE® Customer Center with repositories and registration targets. This helps you to centrally manage software updates within a firewall on a per-system basis, while maintaining your corporate security policies and regulatory compliance.

RMT allows you to provision updates for all your devices running a product based on SUSE Linux Enterprise. By downloading these updates once and distributing them throughout the enterprise, you can set more restrictive firewall policies. This also reduces bandwidth usage, as there is no need to download the same updates for each device. RMT is fully supported and available as a download for customers with an active SUSE Linux Enterprise product subscription.

Repository Mirroring Tool provides functionality that can be useful in many situations, including the following:

- You want to update SUSE Linux Enterprise servers.
- Not all machines in your environment can be connected to SUSE Customer Center to register and retrieve updates for bandwidth or security reasons.
- There are SUSE Linux Enterprise hosts that are restricted and difficult to update without putting in place a custom update management solution.
- You need to integrate additional external or internal repositories.

**Figure 1.1. RMT**



RMT replaces SMT (Subscription Management Tool) which was used for SLE 11 and SLE 12. For a feature comparison between RMT and SMT, see *Table 3.1, “Feature comparison”*.



## Chapter 2. RMT installation and configuration

RMT is included in SUSE Linux Enterprise Server starting with version 15. Install RMT directly during the installation of SUSE Linux Enterprise Server or install it on a running system. After the packages are installed, use YaST to do an initial configuration.



### RMT server conflicts with installation server

Configuring a server to be an RMT server installs and configures the NGINX Web server, listening on port 80.

However, configuring a machine to be an installation server automatically installs the Apache Web server and configures it to listen on port 80.

Do not try to enable both these functions on the same server. It is not possible for a single server to host both simultaneously.

### 2.1. Storage requirements

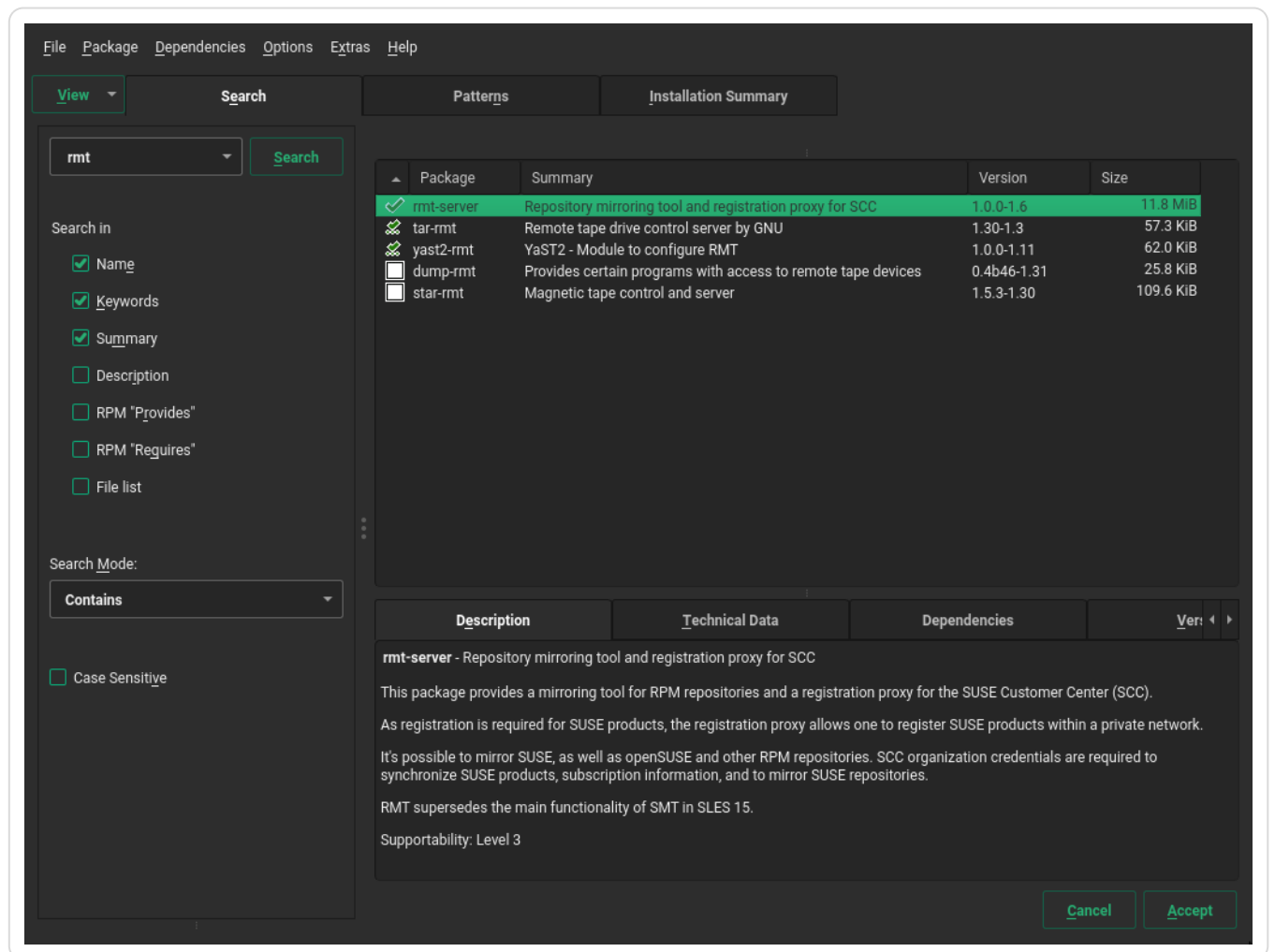
Downloaded packages are stored in `/usr/share/rmt/public/repo`, which is a symbolic link to `/var/lib/rmt/public/repo/`.

The amount of storage your RMT server requires depends on several variables: the number of repositories and architectures that you mirror, and the number of products that are enabled. As a general guide, 1.5 times the total size of all enabled repositories should be sufficient. This is about 200 GB per SUSE Linux Enterprise release, including all extensions.

### 2.2. Installation during system installation

To install it during installation, select the `rmt-server` package. Package selection can be found in *Installation Settings* when selecting *Software*.

**Figure 2.1. RMT pattern**



Check for available RMT updates immediately after installing SUSE Linux Enterprise Server using the **zypper patch** command because SUSE continuously releases maintenance updates for RMT.

## 2.3. Installation on an existing system

To install RMT on a running SUSE Linux Enterprise Server installation, use **zypper**:

```
>sudozypper in rmt-server
```

### 2.3.1. Installation on SLES Minimal VM

SLES Minimal VM is a minimal customizable operating system that is designed for specific usage scenarios, for example, to be run as:

- A container host

- A virtual machine guest
- An appliance base system
- A small server image

SLES Minimal VM image is a good choice for being used as an RMT server. You can download SLES Minimal VM images for KVM, Xen, Microsoft Hyper-V, VMware, and OpenStack from the public SUSE Linux Enterprise Server download page at <https://www.suse.com/download/sles/>. Find more information on SLES Minimal VM at <https://documentation.suse.com/smart/virtualization-cloud/html/minimal-vm/index.html>.

Installing RMT on SLES Minimal VM is the same as installing it on an existing system (see *the section called “Installation on an existing system”*). To install RMT on SLES Minimal VM, run the following command from the SLES Minimal VM command line as `root`:

```
#zypper install rmt-server yast2-rmt nginx mariadb
```

### Hardware requirements



When installing RMT on SLES Minimal VM, be aware that it requires a minimum of 100 GB disk space, depending on the products you select to mirror. Another requirement is a CPU with at least two cores and 2 GB of RAM.

## 2.4. Deploying RMT on top of the Kubernetes cluster

This section describes how to deploy RMT on top of the Kubernetes cluster. It uses *Helm* as the package manager to interact with the Kubernetes cluster. Find more details about using Helm at [https://helm.sh/docs/intro/using\\_helm/](https://helm.sh/docs/intro/using_helm/).

### 2.4.1. Prerequisites

- Running Kubernetes cluster
- `helm` command configured to interact with the cluster

### 2.4.2. Application components

Each component of the RMT application is deployed in its own container. RMT consists of the following components:

## RMT server

Containerized version of the RMT application server with the ability to pass its configuration via Helm values. Storage is done on a volume that is allocated to the Kubernetes cluster. You need to adjust the size of the storage depending on the number of repositories you need to mirror.

## MariaDB

The database back-end for RMT. No post-installation task is needed since RMT creates the required database and tables at start-up. If passwords are not specified in the `values.yaml` file, they are generated automatically.

## Nginx

A Web server configured for RMT routes. Having a properly configured Web server allows you to target your Ingress traffic (for RMT) to this Nginx service directly. You do not need to configure Ingress for RMT specific paths handling, as Nginx is configured to take care of this itself.

### 2.4.3. The `values.yaml` file

The RMT chart includes the `values.yaml` file where all parameters are documented and their default values are defined. You can override these values by providing your own values file, for example:

```

>cat << EOF > rmt-config.yaml
---
app:
  storage:
    class: local-path❶
  scc:
    enabled: false
    username: "UXXXXXXX"
    password: "PASSXXXX"
    products_enable:
      - SLES/15.3/x86_64
      - sle-module-python2/15.3/x86_64
    products_disable:
      - sle-module-legacy/15.3/x86_64
      - sle-module-cap-tools/15.3/x86_64
db:
  storage:
    class: local-path❷
ingress:
  enabled: true
  hosts:
    - host: chart-example.local
      paths:
        - path: "/"
        pathType: Prefix
  tls:
    - secretName: rmt-cert
      hosts:
        - chart-example.local
EOF

```

❶❷ The local-path storage class is only available in Rancher workloads. To make the helm chart succeed, you need to install the local-path storage provisioner by running the following command:

```
>kubectl apply -f https://raw.githubusercontent.com/rancher/local-path-provisioner/v0.0.0
```

And to install RMT, run:

```
>helm install rmtsle oci://registry.suse.com/suse/rmt-helm -f rmt-config.yaml
```

### 2.4.3.1. Required values

**Key:** app.scc.password

**Type:** string

**Default:** nil

**Description:** [SUSE Customer Center](#) proxy password. The password string needs to be put inside quotes. If the quote character " is part of the string, it has to be escaped with \.

**Key:** app.scc.username

**Type:** string

**Default:** nil

**Description:** [SUSE Customer Center](#) proxy user name. The user name string needs to be put inside quotes. If the quote character " is part of the string, it has to be escaped with \.

**Key:** app.scc.products\_enable

**Type:** list

**Default:** []

**Description:** list of products to enable for mirroring

**Key:** app.scc.products\_disable

**Type:** list

**Default:** []

**Description:** list of products to disable for mirroring

**Key:** app.storage.class

**Type:** string

**Default:** ""

**Description:** Kubernetes storageclass.

**Key:** db.storage.class

**Type:** string

**Default:** ""

**Description:** Kubernetes storageclass.

**Key:** ingress.enabled

**Type:** bool

**Default:** `false`

**Description:** Ingress Enabled

**Key:** `ingress.hosts[0]`

**Type:** object

**Default:** `{ "host": "chart-example.local", "paths": [ { "path": "/", "path-Type": "Prefix" } ] }`

**Description:** DNS name at which the RMT service will be accessible from clients

**Key:** `ingress.tls[0].hosts[0]`

**Type:** string

**Default:** `"chart-example.local"`

**Description:** DNS name at which the RMT service will be accessible from clients

**Key:** `ingress.tls[0].secretName`

**Type:** string

**Default:** `"rmt-cert"`

**Description:** TLS Ingress Certificate

## 2.5. RMT configuration with YaST

Configure RMT with YaST as described in the following procedure. It is assumed that this procedure is executed on a newly installed system.

1. Start YaST with the `rmt` module.

```
> sudo yast2 rmt
```

Alternatively, start YaST and select *Network Services > RMT Configuration*.

2. Enter your organization credentials. To retrieve your credentials, refer to *the section called "Mirroring credentials"*.
3. Enter credentials for a new MariaDB user and database name, and confirm with *Next*.

If a password for the MariaDB `root` user is already set, you are required to enter it. If no password is set for `root`, you are asked to enter a new one.

4. Enter a common name for the SSL certificates. The common name should be the *fully qualified domain name (FQDN)* of the server. Enter all domain names and IP addresses with which you want to reach the RMT server as alternative common names.

When all common names are entered, select *Next*.



### Certificate locations for RMT

- `/etc/rmt/ssl/rmt-ca.crt`

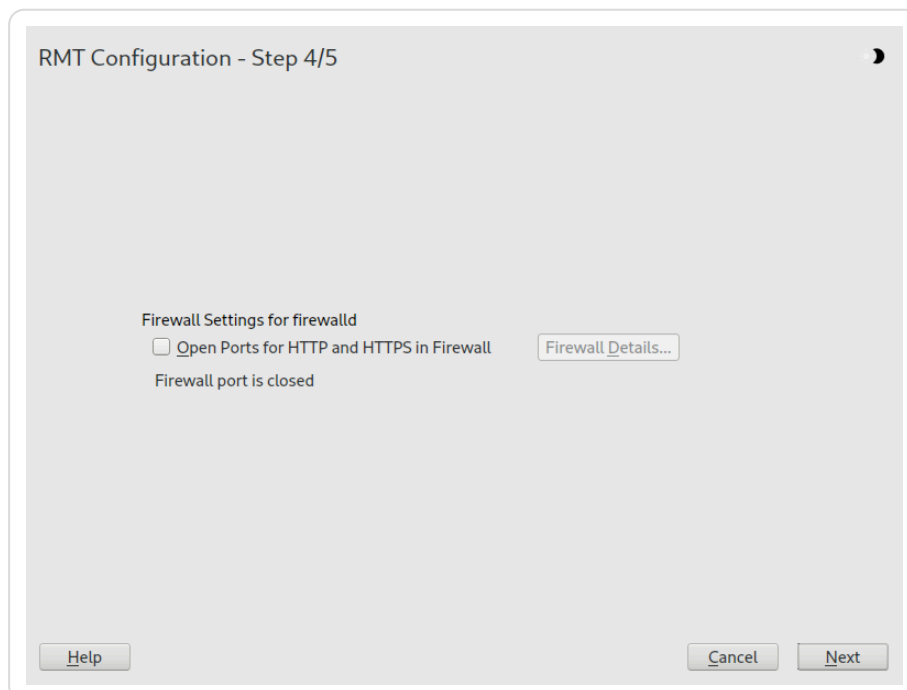
This is the CA certificate bundle that **yast2 rmt** uses to certify the RMT server certificate. **yast2 rmt** only creates this file if it does not already exist.

- `/etc/rmt/ssl/rmt-server.crt` and `/etc/rmt/ssl/rmt-server.key`

**yast2 rmt** only generates a new server certificate and private key if one does not already exist. To regenerate this certificate, refer to *the section called “Regenerating HTTPS certificates”*.

5. If `firewalld` is enabled on this system, enable the check box to open the required ports.

**Figure 2.2. Enabling ports in `firewalld`**



If `firewalld` is not enabled now and you plan to enable it later, you can always open relevant ports by running the **yast2 rmt** module.





### Fine-tuning firewalld settings

By clicking *Firewall Details*, you can open the relevant ports for specific network interfaces only.

Continue with *Next*.

6. To view the summary, click *Next*. Close YaST by clicking *Finish*. YaST then enables and starts all `systemd` services and timers.

## 2.6. Enabling SLP announcements

RMT includes the SLP service description file `/etc/slp.reg.d/rmt-server.reg`. To enable SLP announcements of the RMT service, follow these steps:

1. If `firewalld` is running, open relevant ports and reload the `firewalld` configuration:

```
>sudo firewall-cmd --permanent --add-port=427/tcp
success
>sudo firewall-cmd --permanent --add-port=427/udp
success
>sudo firewall-cmd --reload
```

2. Verify that the SLP server is installed and install it if it is not:

```
>sudo zypper install openslp-server
```

3. Enable and start the SLP service:

```
>sudo systemctl enable slpd.service
>sudo systemctl restart slpd.service
```

## 2.7. Accessing SUSE Customer Center behind a firewall

If the RMT server is behind a firewall and cannot access SUSE Customer Center directly, you need to allow connections to the following domains for both 80 and 443 ports on the firewall.

- `scc.suse.com`
- `updates.suse.com`
- `installer-updates.suse.com`

If the firewall you are using does not support host name allowlisting—such as `firewalld`—you need to allow connections to the corresponding IP addresses as described in the following steps.

1. Resolve the IP address of the domain, for example, `installer-updates.suse.com`.

```
>nslookup installer-updates.suse.com
[...]
Address: 152.199.22.115
```

2. Add firewall rules for ports 80 and 443 for each discovered IP address.

```
>sudofirewall-cmd --permanent --zone=public \ --add-rich-rule='rule family="ipv4" sou
```

```
>sudo firewall-cmd --permanent --zone=public \ --add-rich-rule='rule family="ipv4" sou
```

3. Reload the firewall configuration.

```
>sudo firewall-cmd --reload
```

## Chapter 3. Migrate from SMT to RMT

This chapter describes the migration from SMT on SLES 11 or 12 to RMT on SLES 15.

### 3.1. Important notes



#### Read this section carefully

Carefully read this section. It contains vital information about the migration process.

#### Use a new host

We recommend that you install RMT on a newly installed SLES 15 host. RMT is not a complete replacement for SMT. It has a different workflow than SMT and only supports registering SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 12 systems and newer.

#### Repository metadata and settings

The settings of staged repositories are *not* exported from SMT. Repositories that have been marked to be mirrored are exported.

#### Custom repositories

It is only possible to export repositories that are marked for mirroring.

#### Expired subscriptions

Products no longer available on the organization subscriptions will not be available on RMT.

#### Client information

Systems and their activated products are exported. SMT client jobs and patch status are not exported from SMT.

**Table 3.1. Feature comparison**

| Feature              | SMT | RMT |
|----------------------|-----|-----|
| Available on SLES 11 | yes | no  |
| Available on SLES 12 | yes | no  |

| Feature                                             | SMT              | RMT              |
|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------|------------------|
| Available on SLES 15                                | no               | yes              |
| Synchronize products with SUSE Customer Center      | yes              | yes              |
| Mirror RPMs from repositories                       | yes              | yes              |
| Selective mirroring (specifying products to mirror) | yes              | yes              |
| Serve RPMs via HTTP                                 | yes              | yes              |
| Registration of SLE 15 systems                      | yes              | yes              |
| Registration of SLE 12 systems                      | yes              | yes              |
| Registration of SLE 11 systems                      | yes              | no               |
| Red Hat 6 and earlier support                       | yes <sup>1</sup> | no               |
| Red Hat 7+ support                                  | yes <sup>1</sup> | yes <sup>1</sup> |
| Support for migrating SLE 12 to 15                  | yes <sup>2</sup> | yes              |
| Support for migrating SLE 15 SPx to 15 SPx+1        | yes <sup>2</sup> | yes              |
| Staging repositories                                | yes              | no <sup>3</sup>  |
| Offline mirroring                                   | yes              | yes              |
| NTLM Proxy support                                  | yes              | yes              |
| Custom repositories                                 | yes              | yes              |
| YaST installation wizard                            | yes              | yes              |
| YaST management wizard                              | yes              | no               |
| Client management                                   | yes              | no               |
| Files deduplication                                 | yes              | yes              |
| Data transfer from SMT to RMT                       | n/a              | yes              |

| Feature                                                      | SMT     | RMT              |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------------|
| Transfer registration data to SUSE Customer Center           | yes     | yes              |
| Reporting                                                    | yes     | no               |
| Custom TLS certificates for Web server                       | yes     | yes              |
| Clean up data from repositories that are not used any longer | yes     | yes              |
| Bash completion                                              | no      | yes              |
| Available on <a href="#">openSUSE Leap 15</a>                | no      | yes <sup>4</sup> |
| Easy development setup + <a href="#">contribution guide</a>  | no      | yes              |
| 100% test <a href="#">coverage</a>                           | no      | yes              |
| <a href="#">Plugin functionality</a>                         | no      | yes              |
| Web server                                                   | Apache2 | Nginx            |
| Platform                                                     | Perl    | Ruby             |
| Clean up data from repositories that are no longer used      | yes     | yes              |
| Bash completion                                              | no      | yes              |
| Option to deploy on Kubernetes                               | no      | yes <sup>5</sup> |

1. Support via SUSE Liberty Linux—find more details in <https://www.suse.com/products/suse-liberty-linux/>.
2. SMT only partially supports migrating systems to SLE 15. SLE 15 is composed of multiple modules and extensions. Some modules are not required, as they provide additional functionality. RMT fully supports migrations into and within SLE 15, therefore it only adds the minimum of required modules. SMT does not fully support these migrations, and it enables all available modules on the system.
3. Functionality is offered by [SUSE Multi-Linux Manager](#).
4. Only available with [self-support](#).

5. Find more details in *the section called “Deploying RMT on top of the Kubernetes cluster”*.

## 3.2. Exporting SMT data

### Procedure 3.1. Export SMT data

1. Update your SMT server installation by running `zypper up`.
2. To export your SSL certificates along with the rest of the data, run `smt-data-export`. Remember to keep your certificates in a safe place.  
If you do not want to export the SSL certificates from SMT, run `smt-data-export --no-ssl-export`.
3. The exported configuration is now saved to `smt-data-export.TIMESTAMP.tar.gz`. Copy the file to a location that the new RMT server can access.

## 3.3. Importing SMT data to RMT

1. To make sure your RMT installation is up to date, run `zypper up`.
2. Copy the exported `.tar.gz` file to an empty directory and unpack it. Then enter the new directory:  

```
>mkdir EMPTY_DIR>cd EMPTY_DIR>tar xf /PATH/TO/smt-data-export.TIMESTAMP.tar.gz>cd smt
```
3. If you chose to export the SSL certificates from SMT, copy the CA private key and certificate to `/etc/rmt/ssl/`:  

```
>sudocp ssl/cacert.key /etc/rmt/ssl/rmt-ca.key>sudocp ssl/cacert.pem /etc/rmt/ssl/rmt
```
4. Run the YaST RMT configuration module as described in *the section called “RMT configuration with YaST”*. If you imported the SMT CA certificate, add the domain of the SMT server to the common names of the new SSL certificate.
5. Run the RMT synchronization to get the products and repositories data from SUSE Customer Center.  

```
>sudormt-cli sync
```
6. Import the data from the SMT server.  

```
>sudormt-data-import -d ./
```
7. Optional: if the URL of the RMT server changed, change the URL parameter of clients in `/etc/SUSEConnect` to point to the new RMT server. Alternatively, change the DNS records to re-assign the host name to the RMT server.
8. Optional: move the mirrored repository data from SMT to RMT, and adjust the ownership of the copied data.  

```
>sudocp -r /var/www/htdocs/repo/* /usr/share/rmt/public/repo/>sudochown -R _rmt:nginx
```



## Tip

The path for storing custom repository data on the RMT server is different from that of SMT. With RMT, it replicates the directory structure of the source server's URL into a top level directory structure of the source server's URL into a top-level `http://download.opensuse.org/debug/distribution/leap/15.7/repo/oss` its path on the RMT server corresponds to `/usr/share/rmt/public/repo/debug/distribution/leap/15.7/repo/oss`

9. Custom repositories on the SMT server are disabled by default. If you want to mirror them to the RMT, enable them before mirroring.

- a. Check for custom repositories by running:

```
>sudo rmt-cli repos custom list
```

The command shows the table of all custom repositories. The first column contains the ID of each repository and the `Mirror?` column shows `false`.

- b. Enable each custom repository you want to mirror by running:

```
>sudo rmt-cli repos custom enable ID
```

10. Update the packages in the repositories by starting the mirroring process:

```
>sudo rmt-cli mirror
```





## Chapter 4. Mirroring repositories on the RMT server

You can mirror the installation and update repositories on the RMT server. This way, you do not need to download updates on each machine, which saves time and capacity.

In its default configuration, RMT mirrors enabled product repositories automatically once every night.

By default, the mirrored repositories are stored in `/var/lib/rmt/public/repo`.



### Change the default location of the mirrored repositories

To change the default location of the mirrored repositories, point the `/usr/share/rmt/public/repo` symbolic link to the desired directory. This can be done using the command:

```
ln -sfn TARGET /usr/share/rmt/public/repo
```

(Replace `TARGET` with the desired destination). Make sure that the target has read and write permissions for the `rmt` user and `nginx` group.

When enabled repositories are fully mirrored, you can register your client systems against RMT by running `SUSEConnect --url https://RMT_HOSTNAME` on the client machine. After successful registration, the repositories from the RMT server are used by Zypper on the client machine.

### SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 11 clients



RMT does not support clients with SUSE Linux Enterprise Server versions 11 and older.

## 4.1. Mirroring credentials

You need organization credentials to create a local mirror of the SUSE Linux Enterprise repositories. You can obtain the credentials from SUSE Customer Center.

To get the credentials from SUSE Customer Center, follow these steps:

1. Visit SUSE Customer Center at <https://scc.suse.com> and log in.
2. If you are a member of multiple organizations, select the organization you want to work with from the sidebar on the left.

3. Select *Proxies* in the top menu.
4. The credentials are displayed in the top right corner.
5. To see the password, click the  icon.

The obtained credentials should be set with the YaST RMT Server Configuration module or added directly to the `/etc/rmt.conf` file. For more information about the `/etc/rmt.conf` file, see *the section called “/etc/rmt.conf”*.

## 4.2. Synchronizing repository metadata

The local RMT database needs to be updated periodically with the information downloaded from SUSE Customer Center. This includes information about available products and repositories.

The synchronization is activated by the `systemd` timer `rmt-server-sync.timer`. To view its status, for example, the next running time, use `systemctl status`.

```
>sudo systemctl status rmt-server-sync.timer
● rmt-server-sync.timer - RMT Sync timer
   Loaded: loaded (/usr/lib/systemd/system/rmt-server-sync.timer; enabled; vendor preset:
   Active: active (waiting) since Fri 2018-06-22 04:22:34 EDT; 2h 34min ago
   Trigger: Sat 2018-06-23 03:53:00 EDT; 20h left

Jun 22 04:22:34 d31 systemd[1]: Started RMT Sync timer.
```

If the timer is not enabled or started, start it manually.

```
>sudo systemctl enable --now rmt-server-sync.timer
```

To update the RMT database manually, use the `rmt-cli sync` command. For details, see *the section called “sync”*.

## 4.3. Mirroring packages

Packages for enabled repositories are mirrored on your RMT server. Packages are downloaded periodically once a day. But the download can also be triggered manually at any time.

The periodic mirroring is activated by the `systemd` timer `rmt-server-mirror.timer`. To show its status, for example, the next running time, use `systemctl status`.

```
#systemctl status rmt-server-mirror.timer
● rmt-server-mirror.timer - RMT Mirror timer
   Loaded: loaded (/usr/lib/systemd/system/rmt-server-mirror.timer; enabled; vendor prese
   Active: active (waiting) since Fri 2018-06-22 04:22:34 EDT; 2h 34min ago
   Trigger: Sat 2018-06-23 02:17:57 EDT; 19h left

Jun 22 04:22:34 d31 systemd[1]: Started RMT Mirror timer.
```

If the timer is not enabled or started, start it manually.

```
>sudo systemctl enable --now rmt-server-mirror.timer
```

To update the mirrored packages manually, use the `rmt-cli mirror` command. For details, see *the section called “mirror”*.

## 4.4. Enabling and disabling mirroring of repositories

You can enable or disable the mirroring of repositories individually or by product. You can specify one or more repositories or products at once. When repositories are enabled, their packages are downloaded and updated during the mirroring process. To enable or disable mirroring of repositories, you either need the product string or ID, or the repository name or ID. Enabling or disabling a product is desired, because this automatically enables or disables all repositories associated with the product.

### 4.4.1. Using products

To enable or disable all repositories of a product, use the `rmt-cli products enable ID` and `rmt-cli products disable ID` commands. To retrieve an ID for an enabled product, use the `rmt-cli products list` command. To get the ID of a disabled product that is still available, run the `rmt-cli products list --all` command.

Example:

```
>sudormt-cli products list --all
```

| ID   | Product              | Version | Arch   | Mirror?      | Last mirrored |
|------|----------------------|---------|--------|--------------|---------------|
| 1743 | SUSE Package Hub     | 15      | x86_64 | Don't Mirror |               |
|      | PackageHub/15/x86_64 |         |        |              |               |

```
>sudormt-cli products enable 1743
```

Found product by target 1743: SUSE Package Hub 15 x86\_64.

Enabling SUSE Package Hub 15 x86\_64:

SUSE Package Hub 15 x86\_64:

Enabled repository SLE-Module-Packagehub-Subpackages15-Pool.

Enabled repository SLE-Module-Packagehub-Subpackages15-Updates.

Enabled repository SUSE-PackageHub-15-Pool.

Enabled repository SUSE-PackageHub-15-Standard-Pool..

```
>sudormt-cli products disable 1743
```

Found product by target 1743: SUSE Package Hub 15 x86\_64.

Disabling SUSE Package Hub 15 x86\_64:

SUSE Package Hub 15 x86\_64:

Disabled repository SLE-Module-Packagehub-Subpackages15-Pool.

Disabled repository SLE-Module-Packagehub-Subpackages15-Updates.

Disabled repository SUSE-PackageHub-15-Pool.

Disabled repository SUSE-PackageHub-15-Standard-Pool.

To clean up downloaded files, run 'rmt-cli repos clean'



## Enabling and disabling multiple products at once

To enable or disable multiple products at once, specify a space-delimited list of their IDs or product strings, for example:

```
>sudormt-cli products enable 1743 SLES/15/x86_64 SLES/12
```

Found product by target 1743: SUSE Package Hub 15 x86\_64.

Enabling SUSE Package Hub 15 x86\_64:

SUSE Package Hub 15 x86\_64:

Enabled repository SLE-Module-Packagehub-Subpackages15-Pool.

Enabled repository SLE-Module-Packagehub-Subpackages15-Updates.

Enabled repository SUSE-PackageHub-15-Pool.

Enabled repository SUSE-PackageHub-15-Standard-Pool.

Found product by target SLES/15/x86\_64: SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 x86\_64.

Enabling SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 x86\_64:

SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 x86\_64:

Enabled repository SLE-Product-SLES15-Pool.

Enabled repository SLE-Product-SLES15-Updates.

Enabled repository SLE15-Installer-Updates.

Basesystem Module 15 x86\_64:

Enabled repository SLE-Module-Basesystem15-Pool.

Enabled repository SLE-Module-Basesystem15-Updates.

Server Applications Module 15 x86\_64:

Enabled repository SLE-Module-Server-Applications15-Pool.

Enabled repository SLE-Module-Server-Applications15-Updates.

Found product by target SLES/12: SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 12 x86\_64.

Enabling SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 12 x86\_64:

SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 12 x86\_64:

Enabled repository SLES12-Pool.

Enabled repository SLES12-Updates.

## 4.4.2. Using repositories

To enable or disable mirroring of specific repositories, use the `rmt-cli repos enable ID` and `rmt-cli repos disable ID` commands. To retrieve an ID for an enabled repository, use the `rmt-cli repos list` command. If you need to get the ID of a disabled but accessible repository, execute the command `rmt-cli repos list --all`.

Example:

```
>sudo rmt-cli repos list --all
+-----+-----+-----+
| ID      | Name                               | Description                               |
+-----+-----+-----+
[...]
| 3061    | SUSE-PackageHub-15-Pool           | SUSE-PackageHub-15-Pool for sle-15-x86_64 |
| [...]  |                                     |                                     |
+-----+-----+-----+

>sudo rmt-cli repos enable 3061
Repository by ID 3061 successfully enabled.

>sudo rmt-cli repos disable 3061
Repository by ID 3061 successfully disabled.

To clean up downloaded files, please run 'rmt-cli repos clean'
```



### Enabling and disabling multiple repositories at once

To enable or disable multiple repositories at once, specify a space-delimited list of their IDs, for example:

```
>sudo rmt-cli repos enable 2526 3263
Repository by ID 2526 successfully enabled.
Repository by ID 3263 successfully enabled.

>sudo rmt-cli repos disable 2526 3263
Repository by ID 2526 successfully disabled.
Repository by ID 3263 successfully disabled.

To clean up downloaded files, run 'rmt-cli repos clean'
```

## 4.5. Deleting mirrored data

After you disable the mirroring of a repository or product as described in *the section called “Enabling and disabling mirroring of repositories”*, the mirrored data remains on your local hard disk. This includes the mirrored RPM packages.

To delete disabled repository data, use the command `rmt-cli repos clean`. With this command, RMT verifies that only enabled repositories are mirrored and provides a way to delete invalid data.

Before removing any data, the command lists the affected repositories and requires the user to input `yes` to continue.

```
>sudo rmt-cli repos clean
```

```
RMT found locally mirrored files from the following repositories which are not marked to be
```

```
SLE-Product-SLES15-Updates for sle-15-x86_64
```

```
SLE-Product-SLES15-Pool for sle-15-x86_64
```

```
SLE15-Installer-Updates for sle-15-x86_64
```

```
Would you like to continue and remove the locally mirrored files of these repositories?  
Only 'yes' will be accepted.
```

```
Enter a value: yes
```

```
Deleted locally mirrored files from repository 'SLE-Product-SLES15-Updates for sle-15-x86_64'
```

```
Deleted locally mirrored files from repository 'SLE-Product-SLES15-Pool for sle-15-x86_64'
```

```
Deleted locally mirrored files from repository 'SLE15-Installer-Updates for sle-15-x86_64'
```

```
Clean finished. An estimated 157 MB were removed.
```



## Manually remove repository data

To delete disabled repository data, manually remove its corresponding directory:

```
>sudo rm -r /usr/share/rmt/public/repo/SUSE/Products/PRODUCT/VERSION/ARCHITECTURE/
```

## 4.6. Adding custom repositories

You can mirror custom repositories with the RMT server. These repositories are not provided by SUSE Customer Center. Repositories can be provided by, for example, the Open Build Service, third-party vendors, or created with `createrepo`.

Custom repositories can either be stand-alone, or you can attach them to products. This allows you to connect multiple repositories with one command on a client registered to the RMT server.

The following example procedure illustrates the mirroring of a third-party repository.

1. Add the remote repository to the RMT server. Replace *URL* with the URL to the repository. Replace *NAME* with a name of your choice for the repository.

```
#rmt-cli repos custom add URLNAME
```

2. List all custom repositories to get the ID of the new repository.

```
#rmt-cli repos custom list
```

3. Optionally attach the new custom repository to a product. For example, if the new custom repository is required by all desktop clients, it can be attached to the SUSE Linux Enterprise Desktop product.

```
#rmt-cli repos custom attach REPOSITORY_IDPRODUCT_ID
```

Replace *REPOSITORY\_ID* with the ID of the new custom repository. Replace *PRODUCT\_ID* with the ID of a product you want the repository to be attached to. If you need to retrieve the *PRODUCT\_ID*, use the command `rmt-cli products list --all`.

### Important



When custom repositories are associated with a product, clients registering with that product see it as disabled. To enable the repository, find its ID with the command `zypper lr` and run:

```
#zypper mr -e REPO_ID
```

4. Enable mirroring of the new custom repository.

```
#rmt-cli repos custom enable REPOSITORY_ID
```

To get a list of all available custom repositories commands, see *the section called “repos”*.

## 4.7. Exporting and importing repositories

RMT has built-in functions to import and export data about available repositories and the mirrored packages. For example, this can be used to speed up the setup of a new RMT server by locally copying already mirrored RPM packages.

Another use case is the *offline mode*. It allows the transfer of data to a disconnected RMT server, for example, to provide updates to computers in an air-gapped network.

The following procedure describes the transfer of data and mirrored RPMs between two RMT servers with a USB drive. The server `sun` is connected to SUSE Customer Center, while `sirius` is a server in an air-gapped network.

1. Log in on the server `sun`.

```
root@sun #rmt-cli syncroot@sun #rmt-cli mirror
```

2. Connect a USB drive, assumed to be `/dev/sdb` and mount it, for example, in `/mnt/external`.

```
root@sun #mount /dev/sdb1 /mnt/external
```

- 3.

- a. Export the data about available repositories and products.

```
root@sun #rmt-cli export data /mnt/external/
```

- b. Export the list of enabled repositories. The exported file is required for exporting the repositories in the next step.

```
root@sun #rmt-cli export settings /mnt/external/
```

- c. Export mirrored RPM packages. Depending on the size of mirrored repositories, this can take a long time.

```
root@sun #rmt-cli export repos /mnt/external/
```

4. Unmount and unplug the disk from `sun` and go to `sirius`.

```
root@sun #umount /mnt/external
```

5. If not yet done, set up RMT on `sirius` by running the `yast2 rmt`. In case of an offline RMT setup, select *Skip* on the *Organization Credentials* screen.

6. Connect the USB drive to `sirius` and mount it in `/mnt/external`.

```
root@sirius #mount /dev/sdb1 /mnt/external
```

- 7.

- a. Import the metadata about available repositories and products.

```
root@sirius #rmt-cli import data /mnt/external/
```

- b. Import mirrored RPM packages. Depending on the size of mirrored repositories, this can take a long time.

```
root@sirius #rmt-cli import repos /mnt/external/
```

8. Enable repositories as required on the `sirius`. For details, see *the section called “Enabling and disabling mirroring of repositories”*.



### Exporting enabled settings from air-gapped server

If your air-gapped server (`sirius`) has many enabled repositories, or if the enabled repositories change frequently, we recommend exporting the repository settings from this server.

The server connected to SUSE Customer Center (`sun`) can then import the exported settings. This ensures that `sun` downloads all data required by `sirius`.



## Chapter 5. Configuring clients to use RMT

Any machine running SUSE Linux Enterprise 12 or newer can be configured to register against RMT and download software updates from there, instead of communicating directly with SUSE Customer Center.



### Register with the RMT server over HTTP

We recommend registering with the RMT server over a secured HTTPS protocol (all examples in this documentation use it). However, you can also register with the RMT server over an insecure HTTP protocol. Use this approach only if your setup benefits from it **and** only in a trusted environment where security is not crucial.

To configure clients to use the RMT server, use one of the following methods:

- Provide the required information with boot parameters. See *the section called “Configuring clients with boot parameters”*.
- Configure the clients using an AutoYaST profile. See *the section called “Configuring clients with AutoYaST profile”*.
- Use the `rmt-client-setup` command. See *the section called “Configuring clients with `rmt-client-setup`”*.
- Use the YaST registration module during installation or later. See *the section called “Configuring clients with YaST”*.



### CA certificate

If you need the CA certificate of the RMT server, find it at `/etc/rmt/ssl/rmt-ca.crt` and `https://RMT_SERVER/rmt.crt`.

### 5.1. Configuring clients with boot parameters

Any client can be configured to use RMT by providing the `regurl` parameter during machine boot.

The parameter needs to be entered as `regurl=RMT_SERVER_URL`. The URL needs to be in the following format: `https://FQDN`, with `FQDN` being the fully qualified host name of the RMT server. It must be identical to the FQDN of the server certificate used on the RMT server. Example:

```
regurl=https://rmt.example.com
```



### Beware of typing errors

Make sure the values you enter are correct. If `regurl` has not been specified correctly, the registration of the update source fails.



### Change of RMT server certificate

If the RMT server gets a new certificate from an untrusted CA, the clients need to retrieve the new CA certificate file. YaST displays a dialog for importing a new certificate. If you confirm importing the new certificate, the old one is replaced with the new one.

## 5.2. Configuring clients with AutoYaST profile

Clients can be configured to register with the RMT server via an AutoYaST profile. To learn about creating AutoYaST profiles and preparing for automatic installation, refer to the *AutoYaST Guide*. In this section, only RMT specific configuration is described.

To configure RMT specific data using AutoYaST, follow the steps for the relevant version of the RMT client.

1. As `root`, start YaST and select *Miscellaneous > Autoinstallation* to start the graphical AutoYaST front-end.  
From a command line, you can start the graphical AutoYaST front-end with the `yast2 autoyast` command.
2. Open an existing profile using *File > Open*. Create a profile based on the current system's configuration using *Tools > Create Reference Profile*, or work with an empty profile.
3. Select *Software > Product Registration*. An overview of the current configuration is shown.
4. Click *Edit*.
5. Check *Register the Product*, set the URL of the RMT server in *Use Specific Server URL Instead of the Default*, and you can set the *Optional SSL Server Certificate URL*. The possible values for the server URL are the same as for the kernel parameter `regurl`. For the SSL certificate location, you can use either HTTP or HTTPS based URLs.
6. Perform all other configurations needed for the systems to be deployed, then click *Finish* to return to the main screen.
7. Select *File > Save As* and enter a file name for the profile, such as `autoinst.xml`.

### 5.3. Configuring clients with `rmt-client-setup`

The `/usr/share/rmt/public/tools/rmt-client-setup` script is provided in the package `rmt-server`. This script allows you to configure a client machine to use an RMT server. It can also be used to reconfigure an existing client to use a different RMT server.

To configure a client machine to use RMT with `rmt-client-setup`, follow these steps:

1. Download `rmt-client-setup` from the RMT server:

```
#curl http://RMT_SERVER/tools/rmt-client-setup --output rmt-client-setup
```

2. Run the script with the URL of the RMT server as a parameter.

```
#sh rmt-client-setup https://RMT_SERVER/
```

Executing this script imports the RMT CA's certificate into the trusted store.

Alternatively, you can specify the correct fingerprint or path to the server certificate. For details, see `sh rmt-client-setup --help`.

3. The script downloads the server's CA certificate. Accept it by pressing `Y`. The tool now performs all necessary modifications to the client.
4. Use `SUSEConnect` to add more products. For details, run `SUSEConnect --help`.

### 5.4. Configuring clients with YaST

To configure a client to perform the registration against an RMT server, use the YaST *Product Registration* module `yast2 registration`.

On the client, the credentials are not necessary, and you may leave the relevant fields empty. Click *Local Registration Server* and enter its URL. Then click *Next* until the exit from the module.

### 5.5. Configuring clients for custom stand-alone repositories

If you created a custom stand-alone repository on the RMT server, it is not registered on client machines with `SUSEConnect` because it has no parent product.

To add the repository manually, follow these steps:

1. Point your Web browser to the following RMT server URL:

```
https://RMT_SERVER_HOSTNAME/repo/
```

2. Navigate the browser through the directory structure to your custom repository's `repodata/` subdirectory.
3. On the client machine, add the discovered repository URL:

```
>sudo zypper ar CUSTOM_REPO_URLCUSTOM_REPO_NAME
```

## 5.6. Listing accessible repositories

To list available modules and repositories, use `SUSEConnect --list-extensions`. Alternatively, you can also browse the directory listing of the RMT server by visiting `https://RMT_SERVER/repo/` and its subdirectories.

## 5.7. Online migration of SUSE Linux Enterprise clients

SUSE Linux Enterprise clients registered to RMT can be migrated online to the latest service pack of the same major release the same way as clients registered to SUSE Customer Center. Before starting the migration, make sure that RMT has the required products available and mirrored.

For detailed information on the online migration, see Chapter 2, Upgrade paths and methods in [“Upgrade Guide”](#).

## Chapter 6. RMT tools and configuration files

This chapter describes the most important scripts, configuration files and certificates shipped with RMT.

The `rmt-cli` command and its sub-commands are used to manage the mirroring of repositories, registration of clients, and reporting. `systemd` is used for starting, stopping, restarting the RMT service and for checking its status.

The basic configuration for RMT is stored in the `/etc/rmt.conf`.

### 6.1. RMT command line interface (`rmt-cli`)

#### 6.1.1. Overview

The key command to manage the RMT is `rmt-cli` (`/usr/bin/rmt-cli`). The `rmt-cli` command should be used together with the sub-commands described in this section. If the `rmt-cli` command is used alone, it prints a list of all available sub-commands. To get help for individual sub-commands, use `man rmt-cli` or `rmt-cli help [subcommand]`.

The following sub-commands are available:

`rmt-cli sync`

Synchronize database with SUSE Customer Center.

`rmt-cli products`

List and modify products.

`rmt-cli repos`

List and modify repositories.

`rmt-cli mirror`

Mirror repositories.

`rmt-cli systems`

List and modify systems.

**rmt-cli import**

Import commands for offline mode.

**rmt-cli export**

Export commands for offline mode.

**rmt-cli version**

Show RMT version.

The following sections explain each sub-command in detail.

### 6.1.2. sync

This command triggers synchronization with the SUSE Customer Center instantly. The command has no further options. Synchronization is also triggered each night by the `systemd timer` `rmt-server-sync.timer`.

During synchronization, no data is uploaded to the SUSE Customer Center. This command for example updates local product definitions and repository data.

### 6.1.3. products

List and modify products.

**rmt-cli products list [--all] [--csv]**

Lists the products that are enabled for mirroring. Use the `--all` flag to list all available products. Use the `--csv` flag to output the list in CSV format. `ls` can be used as a shortcut for `list`.

**rmt-cli products enable [id | string] [--all-modules]**

Enables mandatory repositories of a product by its ID or product string. The `--all-modules` flag enables all modules of a product instead of only the recommended ones.

**rmt-cli products disable [id | string]**

Disables all repositories of a product by its ID or product string.

### 6.1.4. repos

```
rmt-cli repos list [--all] [--csv]
```

Lists the repositories that are enabled for mirroring. Use the `--all` flag to list all available repositories. Use the `--csv` flag to output the list in CSV format. `ls` can be used as a shortcut for `list`.

```
rmt-cli repos enable [id]
```

Enables mirroring of a single repository by its ID.

```
rmt-cli repos disable [id]
```

Disables mirroring of a single repository by its ID.

```
rmt-cli repos clean
```

Removes locally mirrored files of repositories that are not marked to be mirrored.

### 6.1.5. repos custom

```
rmt-cli repos custom list [--csv]
```

Lists all your custom repositories. Use the `--csv` flag to output the list in CSV format. `ls` can be used as a shortcut for `list`.

```
rmt-cli repos custom add [url] [name] [--id]
```

Adds a new custom repository. Use the `--id` flag to specify a custom alphanumeric ID.

```
rmt-cli repos custom enable [id]
```

Enables mirroring of a custom repository.

```
rmt-cli repos custom disable [id]
```

Disables mirroring of a custom repository.

```
rmt-cli repos custom remove [id]
```

Removes a custom repository.

```
rmt-cli repos custom products [id]
```

Lists the products attached to the custom repository with the given ID.

```
rmt-cli repos custom attach [id] [product id]
```

Attaches an existing custom repository to a product.

```
rmt-cli repos custom detach [id] [product id]
```

Detaches an existing custom repository from a product.

### 6.1.6. mirror

```
rmt-cli mirror
```

Starts the mirroring process manually.

```
rmt-cli mirror all
```

Mirrors all enabled repositories.

```
rmt-cli mirror repository [IDs]
```

Mirrors enabled repositories by a list of IDs.

```
rmt-cli mirror product [IDs]
```

Mirrors enabled repositories for a product by a list of IDs.

### 6.1.7. systems

```
rmt-cli systems list
```

This command lists registered systems.

```
rmt-cli systems scc-sync
```

This command forwards registered systems' data to SCC.

```
rmt-cli systems remove [TARGET]
```

This command removes a system from RMT as identified by the *Login* column of the output of the `rmt-cli systems list` command.



## **rmt-cli systems purge**

This command lists and provides the option to delete inactive systems. It has the following options:

- `--before DATE`—lists systems that have been inactive since *DATE* until now. Default is the last 3 months.
- `--no-confirmation`—allows the administrator to delete matching systems without confirmation.

```
#rmt-cli systems purge --before 2021-06-16
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
| Login      | Hostname | Registration time | Last seen          | Products |
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
| SCC_c5b0.. | 6e485e48b | 2021-06-11 13:38:07 | 2021-06-11 13:52:01 | SLES/15.. |
| SCC_5fcf.. | node52    | 2021-06-15 13:29:24 | 2021-06-15 13:31:25 | SLES/15.. |
+-----+-----+-----+-----+-----+
Do you want to delete these systems? (y/n) y
Purged systems that have not contacted this RMT since 2021-06-16.
```

### **6.1.8. import**

This command is required for the *offline mode*. For details, see *the section called “Exporting and importing repositories”*.

**rmt-cli import data [path]**

Run this on the offline RMT to read the JSON files from the given path and fill the local database with data.

**rmt-cli import repos [path]**

Run this on the offline RMT to import RPM packages.

### **6.1.9. export**

This command is required for the *offline mode*. For details, see *the section called “Exporting and importing repositories”*.

**rmt-cli export data [path]**

Run this on an online RMT to get the latest data from SUSE Customer Center and save the result as JSON files at the specified path.

**rmt-cli export settings [path]**

Run this on the offline RMT to save the settings for enabled repositories at a given path as `repos.json`.

**rmt-cli export repos [path]**

Run this regularly on the online RMT to mirror the set of repositories specified in the `repos.json` at the given path. The mirrored repository files are stored in subdirectories of the same path.

### 6.1.10. clean packages

The **rmt-cli clean packages** command removes locally mirrored *dangling* files and their database entries. A file is considered to be dangling if it matches all the following characteristics:

- It exists in a repository directory with primary and metadata `repomd.xml` files.
- It is no longer referenced in the metadata files.
- It is at least two days old.

You can pass the following options to the **rmt-cli clean packages** command:

#### **--dry-run**

Generates a report of all affected files without actually cleaning them or their database entries.

#### **--verbose**

Prints detailed information about each cleaned file.

#### **--non-interactive**

Skips confirmation before proceeding with the cleaning process.

### 6.1.11. version

Display the version of **rmt-cli**.

## 6.2. RMT systemd commands

You can manage RMT-related services with the standard `systemd` commands. The RMT server has the following services and timers:

### `rmt-server.target`

A `systemd` target that starts all required RMT components.

### `rmt-server.service`

The RMT server.

### `rmt-server-migration.service`

This service migrates the database to the newest schema, if required. There is no need to manually interact with this service.

### `rmt-server-sync.timer`

This timer is responsible for periodically synchronizing all repository product data from the SUSE Customer Center.

### `rmt-server-mirror.timer`

This timer is responsible for periodically synchronizing all RPMs from the SUSE Customer Center.

Use `systemctl` to manage the RMT services and timers.

## 6.3. RMT configuration files

The main RMT configuration file is `/etc/rmt.conf`. You can set most of the options with the YaST RMT Server module.

### 6.3.1. `/etc/rmt.conf`

The only supported way of doing the initial configuration is with `yast2 rmt` as described in *the section called “RMT configuration with YaST”*. Only the proxy configuration needs to be entered manually. The other configuration parameters are documented for reference.

All available configuration options can be found in the `/etc/rmt.conf` file.

### 6.3.1.1. Mirroring settings

The `mirroring` section lets you adjust mirroring behavior.

#### **mirror\_src**

Decides whether to mirror source RPM packages (architecture is `src`).

#### **dedup\_method**

Creates hard links during mirroring when set to `hardlink`. If the file system does not support hard links, it can be set to `copy` instead. Possible values: `hardlink`, `copy`.

### 6.3.1.2. HTTP client settings

The `http_client` section defines the global HTTP connection settings of RMT.

#### **verbose**

Enables additional debug output to the `systemd` journal.

#### **proxy**

The proxy server URL including the protocol and the port number. For example: `http://proxy_url:8080`.

#### **noproxy**

A list of domains that should *not* go through the proxy, separated by commas. For example: `localhost.mylocaldomain`.

#### **proxy\_auth**

This setting determines the proxy authentication mechanism. Possible values are: `none`, `basic`, `digest`, `gssnegotiate`, `ntlm`, `digest_ie`, `ntlm_wb`.

#### **proxy\_user**

The proxy server user name.

#### **proxy\_password**

The proxy server password.

#### **low\_speed\_limit**

Lower speed limit when a download should be aborted in bytes/sec.

#### **low\_speed\_time**

Time until a download gets aborted, when download speed is below `low_speed_limit`.

### **6.3.1.3. Settings for accessing SUSE repositories**

The `scs` section contains your mirroring credentials for contacting the SUSE Customer Center. To obtain your mirroring credentials, see *the section called “Mirroring credentials”*.

Valid configuration keys for the section are:

#### **username**

Mirroring credentials user name.

#### **password**

Mirroring credentials password.

### **6.3.1.4. Web server settings**

The `web_server` section lets you tune the performance of your RMT server.

#### **min\_threads**

Specifies the minimum number of threads that an RMT server worker should spawn.

Acceptable values: Integer greater than or equal to 1.

#### **max\_threads**

Specifies the maximum number of threads that an RMT server worker should spawn.

Acceptable values: Integer greater than or equal to 1.

#### **workers**

Specifies the number of Web workers for RMT.

Acceptable values: Integer greater than or equal to 1.

### 6.3.2. SSL certificates and HTTPS

By default access to API endpoints consumed by **SUSEConnect** is limited to HTTPS only. nginx is configured to use an SSL certificate and a private key from the following locations:

- **Certificate:** `/etc/rmt/ssl/rmt-server.crt`
- **Private key:** `/etc/rmt/ssl/rmt-server.key`

The YaST RMT module generates a custom certificate authority which is used to sign HTTPS certificates. This means that to register, this certificate authority must be trusted by the client machines:

- For registrations during installation from the media or with YaST Registration module, a message will appear, prompting to trust the server certificate.
- For registering a client system on the command line, use the `rmt-client-setup` script. For details, see *the section called “Configuring clients with `rmt-client-setup`”*.

## Chapter 7. Backing up an RMT server

This chapter explains how to create a backup of your RMT server and how to restore from it.

### 7.1. Creating a backup

This procedure details how to create a full backup of your RMT server. It is assumed that you have an external disk or network share mounted in `/mnt/backup` that serves as a target for the backup.

1. Change to the backup directory.

```
#cd /mnt/backup
```

2. Create a file containing a dump of your SQL database. You need to provide the password you set for the `rmt` database user during the installation.

```
#mysqldump -u rmt -p rmt > rmt_backup.sql
```

3. Optionally, create a copy of your mirrored data.

```
#mkdir repos#rmt-cli export repos ./repos/
```

### 7.2. Restoring a backup

This procedure details how to restore your RMT server from a backup created in *the section called “Creating a backup”*. It is assumed that the backup is mounted in `/mnt/backup`. It is also assumed that you are restoring the server on a newly installed SLES.

1. Install and configure the RMT server as described in *Chapter 2, RMT installation and configuration*.
2. Go to the backup directory.

```
#cd /mnt/backup/
```

3. Use `mysql` to remove the newly created database and import the data.

```
#mysql -u rmt -p
Enter password:
Welcome to the MariaDB monitor.  Commands end with ; or \g.
[...]

MariaDB [(none)]>DROP DATABASE rmt;
Query OK, 14 rows affected (0.84 sec)

MariaDB [(none)]>CREATE DATABASE rmt;
Query OK, 1 row affected (0.00 sec)

MariaDB [(none)]>use rmt;
Database changed

MariaDB [rmt]>source rmt_backup.sql;
[...]

MariaDB [rmt]>quit
```

4. Optionally, import the exported repositories.

```
#rmt-cli import repos ./repos/
```

5. Synchronize your data and update your repositories.

```
#rmt-cli sync#rmt-cli mirror
```



## Chapter 8. Managing TLS/SSL certificates

### 8.1. Regenerating HTTPS certificates

HTTPS certificates should be regenerated before they expire or to include additional common alternative names. No additional actions are required on the client machines registered to the RMT server if only HTTPS certificates are regenerated.

1. Stop nginx and rmt-server services.

```
#systemctl stop nginx#systemctl stop rmt-server
```

2. Remove previously generated certificates.

```
#rm /etc/rmt/ssl/rmt-server.*
```

3. Run the `yast rmt` module as described in *the section called “RMT configuration with YaST”*.

### 8.2. Regenerating CA certificates and HTTPS certificates

CA certificates can be regenerated after they have expired or in case of security issues.



#### Import CA certificate on all clients

The newly generated CA certificate must be imported on all clients registered to the RMT server. This can be done by running the `rmt-client-setup` script on the client machines as described in *the section called “Configuring clients with `rmt-client-setup`”*.

1. Stop nginx and rmt-server services.

```
#systemctl stop nginx#systemctl stop rmt-server
```

2. Remove previously generated CA and HTTPS certificates.

```
#rm /etc/rmt/ssl/rmt-ca.*#rm /etc/rmt/ssl/rmt-server.*
```

3. Run the `yast rmt` module as described in *the section called “RMT configuration with YaST”*.

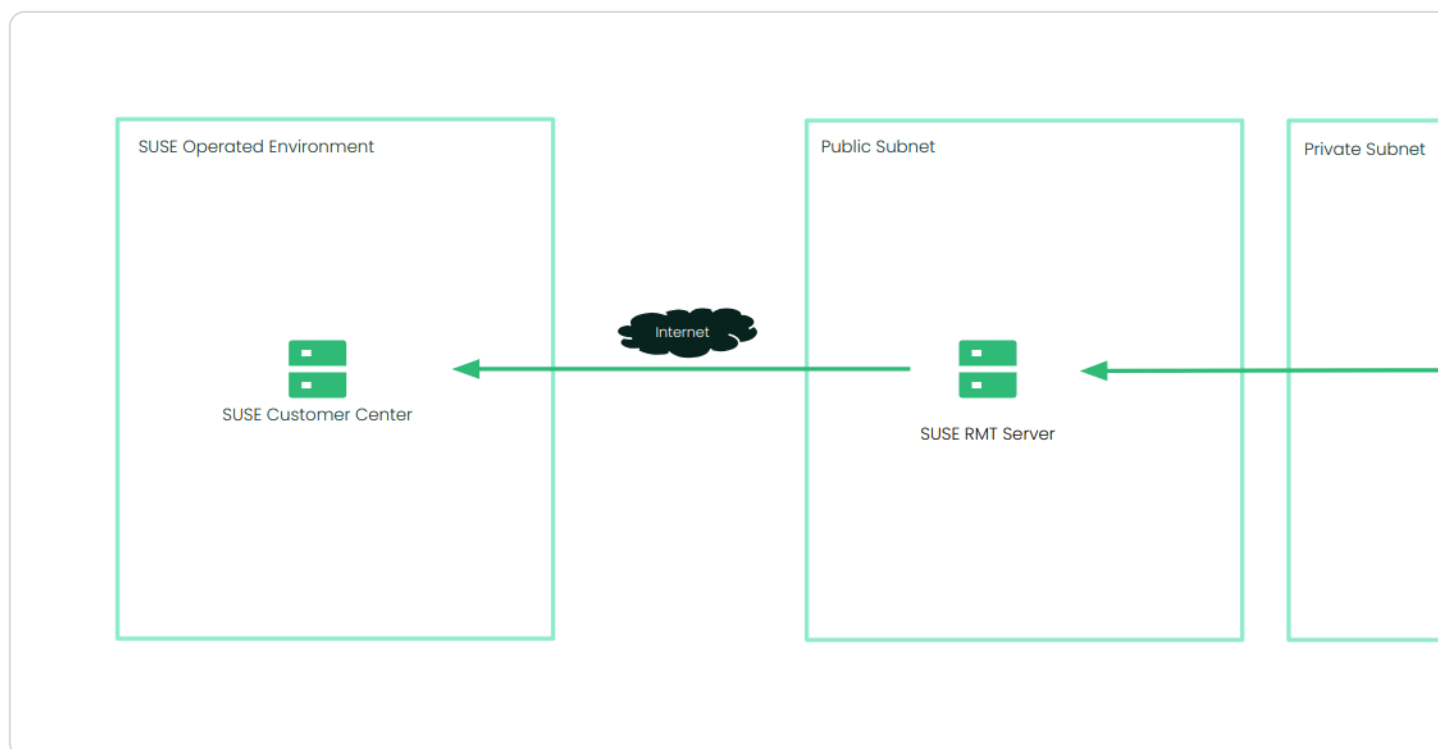


## Chapter 9. Deploying a SUSE Linux Enterprise Server instance to support RMT in the public cloud

You can deploy a SUSE Linux Enterprise Server instance to support RMT in Amazon Web Services (AWS), Google Cloud Platform (GCP), and Microsoft Azure. RMT is included in SLES starting with version 15.

The following example shows a generic cloud architecture for the RMT deployment. Your deployment may look different based on your networking requirements.

**Figure 9.1. An example of cloud architecture for RMT deployment**



### 9.1. Using a bring-your-own-subscription image

SUSE provides images for SLES in Amazon Web Services, Google Cloud and Microsoft Azure. There are two types of images available: PAYG (Pay-As-You-Go) and BYOS (Bring-Your-Own-Subscription). These images are updated at regular intervals and it is suggested that you deploy new instances from the latest version of the image to ensure the most recent security updates are in place. To support RMT deployment, we recommend deploying an RMT instance from a BYOS image.

### 9.1.1. Finding images in the cloud marketplace

The location of the relevant image in each of the cloud provider is shown below:

**Figure 9.2. Google Cloud**

**Marketplace**

Marketplace > "SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 BYOS" > Operating systems

11 results

**Category**

- Operating systems

**Type**

- Virtual machines (11)

**Price**

- Free (11)

**SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 SP5 BYOS**  
SUSE  
This listing does not include a subscription for updates or support. Contact cloud@... one of the leading Enterprise distributions. With the introduction of modules SLES 1... gap between faster moving stacks with a long term maintained stable base.

**SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 SP3 BYOS**  
SUSE  
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**SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 SP4 BYOS**  
SUSE  
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**SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 SP2 BYOS**  
SUSE  
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Figure 9.3. Amazon Web Services

☰

Choose an Amazon Machine Image (AMI)

An AMI is a template that contains the software configuration (operating system, application server, and applications) required to launch your instance. You can select an AMI provided by AWS, our user community, or the AWS Marketplace; or you can select one of your own AMIs.

Selected AMI: (ami-05842291b9a0bd79f) (Quick Start AMIs)

🔍 SLES byos

Quick Start AMIs (0)  
Commonly used AMIs

My AMIs (8)  
Created by me

AWS Marketplace AMIs (7)  
AWS & trusted third-party AMIs

Community AMIs (53)  
Published by anyone

▼ Refine results

Categories  
Infrastructure Software (7)

▼ Publisher  
☐ SUSE (7)

▼ Pricing model  
☐ Bring Your Own License (7)

Operating system  
☐ ▶ All Linux/Unix

▼ Architecture  
☐ 64-bit (x86) (6)  
☐ 64-bit (Arm) (1)

SLES byos (7 results) showing 1 - 7



[SUSE SLES for SAP Applications 15 Family - Hardened BYOS](#)

By [SUSE](#) | Ver SLES SAP 15 SP6 Hardened BYOS (x86\_64) - v20240703

SUSE Linux Enterprise Server for SAP Applications (SLES for SAP) is a powerful operating system for SAP HANA deployments. SLES for SAP...



[SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 Family - BYOS x86\\_64](#)

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SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 (SLES 15) is a secure yet versatile Linux operating system for enabling streamlined IT...



[SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 12 Family - BYOS](#)

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SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 12 (SLES 12) is a secure yet versatile Linux operating system for enabling streamlined IT...



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By [SUSE](#) | Ver SLES 15 SP6 BYOS (arm64) - v20240704

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[SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 Family - Hardened BYOS x86\\_64](#)

By [SUSE](#) | Ver SLES 15 SP6 Hardened BYOS (x86\_64) - v20240626

SUSE Linux Enterprise Server 15 (SLES 15) is a secure yet versatile Linux operating system for enabling streamlined IT...



[SUSE Linux Enterprise Server for SAP Applications 15 Family - BYOS](#)

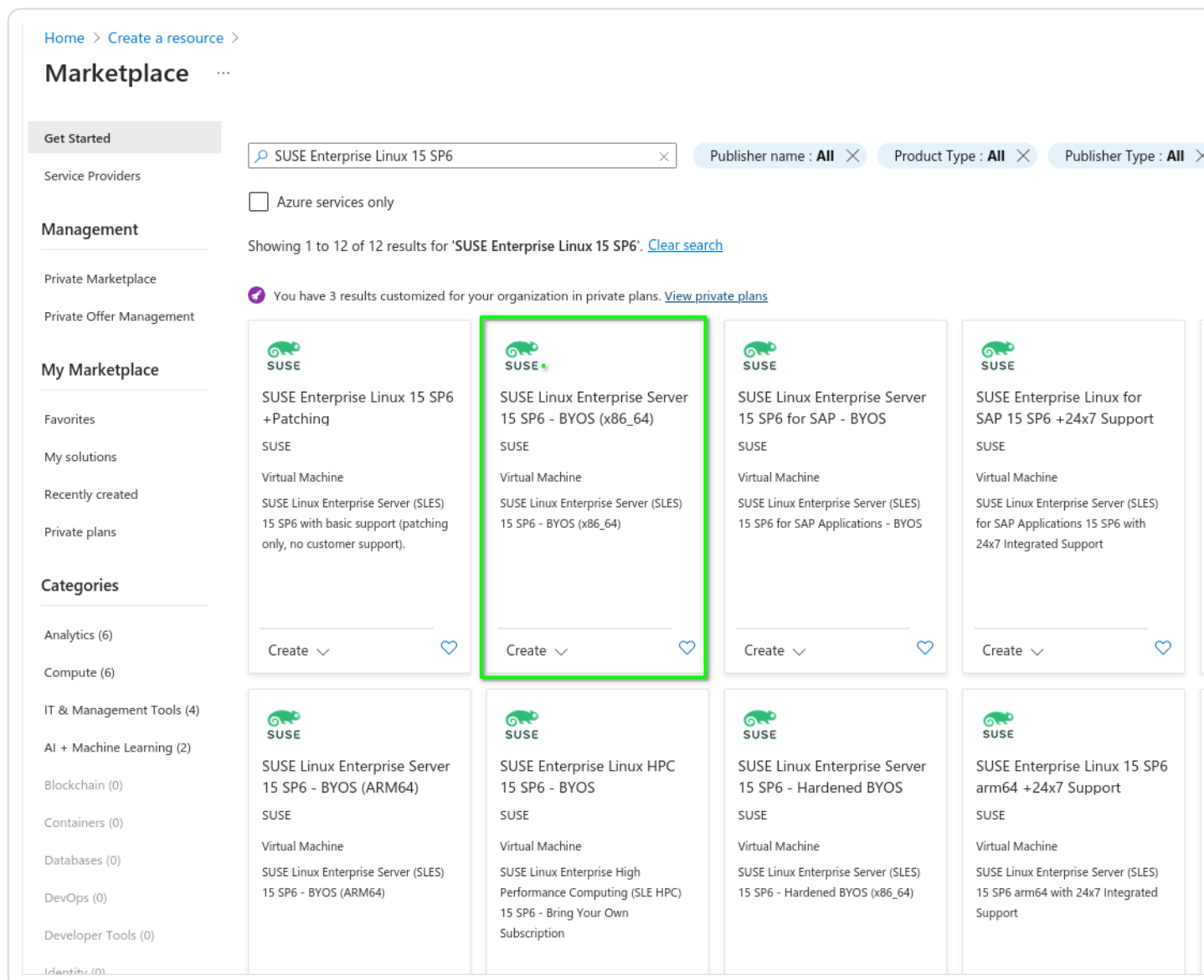
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SUSE Linux Enterprise Server for SAP Applications (SLES for SAP) is a powerful operating system for SAP HANA deployments. SLES for SAP...

CloudShell

Feedback

**Figure 9.4. Microsoft Azure**



It is recommended to start with an instance type that has at least two vCPUs and a minimum of 8 GB RAM to support the RMT deployment. For example, on Amazon EC2, this could be a `t3.large` instance type, and in Microsoft Azure, it could be a `B2as_v2`. The instance can be rightsized as needed and depends on the number of clients being managed and updated by the RMT server.

### 9.1.2. Registering the SLES instance

After the SLES instance deployment, you must register the instance with the SUSE Customer Center.



## SUSE account

Registering with the SUSE Customer Center requires a SUSE account. If you do not have a SUSE account yet, go to the SUSE Customer Center home page (<https://scc.suse.com/>) to create one.

To connect your instance:

AWS:

```
>ssh -i SSH_KEYEC2_USER_ID@SERVER_IP
```

Google Cloud:

```
>gcloud compute ssh GCE_INSTANCE_IP
```

Azure:

```
>ssh AZURE_USER_ID@SERVER_IP
```

To register the SLES instance with SCC:

```
>sudoSUSEConnect -e EMAIL_ADDRESS -r REGISTRATION_CODE
```

The registration code is available once you log in to SCC.

## 9.2. Considerations when using RMT

You must consider the following requirements when you use RMT:

### Disk space

The RMT server requires sufficient disk space to mirror the repositories. Downloaded packages are available in `/var/lib/rmt/public/repo/`. Disk space is dependent on the number of repositories you mirror. We recommend a minimum of 1.5 times the total size of all enabled repositories. It is a best practice to provision an additional disk volume to support this requirement. You can either mount the volume to `/var/lib/rmt/public/repo/` on instance creation or immediately after the launch. For Azure, this is an additional disk volume. For AWS, it is an Amazon EBS volume and for GCP, it is a persistent disk volume .

## IP or DNS resolution

A static IP address or a DNS name is required in order for clients to connect to the RMT server. In Azure, AWS and GCP, a DNS provided by the Cloud Service Provider (CSP) is assigned when the instance is launched. This IP or DNS may change if the instance is re-created. For Azure, consider using a static IP address to provide a consistent connection point for your clients. In AWS, this would be an elastic IP or Route53. In GCP, this would be a cloud DNS record that uses a static IP address.

## Connectivity for the RMT server

The RMT server can connect to SCC on ports 80 and 443. There are many ways to provide connectivity. For example, in AWS, connectivity to SCC can be provided via an AWS Internet Gateway, an AWS NAT Gateway, or via a local data center (VPN/DX Connection) but this depends on whether the RMT instance is in a public or private subnet. GCP provides direct access to the Internet via the VPC routes or Cloud NAT services. Azure offers similar services.

## Connectivity for clients

Clients can connect to RMT on ports 80 and 443. When launching the SLES instance to support RMT, check if network connectivity allows inbound access to the RMT server from your clients (HTTP/HTTPS). For AWS, when a SLES instance is launched to support RMT, it is possible to use an existing AWS security group or a new one. The security group must be configured to allow inbound access to the RMT server from your clients. For GCP, the firewall rules must be configured to allow inbound access to the RMT server from your clients.

## 9.3. More information

- <https://documentation.suse.com/sles/15-SP6/html/SLES-all/cha-rmt-mirroring.html#sec-rmt-mirroring-credentials> Organization credentials to create a local mirror of the SUSE Linux Enterprise repositories.
- <https://documentation.suse.com/sles/15-SP6/html/SLES-all/cha-register-sle.html#sec-register-sle-installation> Register and activate SUSE Linux Enterprise Server with the SUSE Customer Center.



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